# Soil Moisture Pilot Study

## 1. Background

Farmers in the valley have reported uneven crop growth on terraced fields. The pilot study tests whether low-cost sensors can explain these differences.

## 2. Approach

The team placed sensors at three depths on twelve terraces. Readings were taken every hour from May to August.

### 2.1 Data

Each sensor stores its readings on a memory card that is collected weekly. Missing values are flagged rather than filled in.

### 2.2 Procedure

Field staff follow the same steps at each visit:

1. Record the time of arrival and the weather conditions.
2. Check that every sensor is still upright and undamaged.
3. Replace the memory card and label the old card with the terrace number.
4. Clean the solar panel with a dry cloth.
5. Note any changes to the terrace, such as new planting or erosion.

## 3. Next Steps

The results will be shared with the farmers at a meeting in the autumn.